

ATHARVA NAYAK

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SUMMARY

I am a graduate from Pratt Institute with an M.S. in Information Experience Design. Over the last two years I've worked with clients like NYC DCWP, Woven by Toyota, and the University of Alberta Library, delivering design recommendations backed by user research and usability testing, and translating them into high-fidelity Figma designs. Lately I am learning agentic development, and I'm proficient in Cursor and Claude Code, using them in my workflow to prototype and ship production-level mobile apps and websites.

EDUCATION

Pratt Institute , New York, NY	August 2024 - May 2026
Master of Science, Information Experience Design (HCI) GPA: 3.93 / 4.00	
Achievements: Graduated with Academic Honors Received Merit-Based Tuition Scholarship	
University of Mumbai , Mumbai, India	August 2018 - May 2022
Bachelor of Engineering, Electronics and Telecommunication GPA: 8 / 10	

Experience

Center for Digital Experiences, Pratt Institute, NY UX Consultant	August 2024 - May 2026
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NYC Department of Consumer & Worker Protection

- Led end-to-end UX research and redesign of a **licensing portal serving 14,000+ NYC businesses** over 4 months, conducting 10 usability tests, 9 staff interviews, and 3 user interviews to map the end-to-end licensing journey.
- Identified 55 user problems** across 7 themes through affinity mapping and heuristic evaluation, using RICE scoring to prioritize high-impact design opportunities.
- Redesigned 20+ screens** including the application landing page, form, and dashboard, for both desktop and mobile compliant with NYC OTI standards, created an interactive prototype to present to DCWP stakeholders, **the design recommendations were subsequently adopted in the portal's update.**

University of Alberta

- Conducted a usability study** for the University of Alberta Library website, recruiting and running **8 moderated testing sessions** with students and researchers to evaluate navigation, service discovery, and resource accessibility.
- Identified critical usability gaps across 4 key areas: homepage engagement, hours & locations, subject guides, and library services page through affinity mapping and video analysis of user testing.
- Delivered a usability report with **12 prioritized recommendations** and high-fidelity Figma mockups addressing information overload and navigation issues, the recommendations were praised by the library team and incorporated into their UX roadmap.

Gutenberg Technologies

- Planned and conducted a mixed-methods usability study for an enterprise CMS, designed screener and post-study surveys. The study used **eye-tracking** and Retrospective Think-Aloud methodology with **9 participants** to evaluate the content authoring workflow.
- Collected and synthesized quantitative and qualitative data, including task completion rates, completion time, eye-tracking data, and SUS scores, using affinity mapping, rainbow sheets, and gaze analysis (heatmaps, gaze plots, AOI metrics), **identifying 38 usability issues** and prioritizing them by severity through evidence triangulation.
- Delivered 8 evidence-based design recommendations and high-fidelity Figma mockups addressing onboarding confusion and feature discoverability, **proposed an A/B testing plan** to validate solutions and inform Gutenberg's 2026 design overhaul.

PROJECTS

- Woven by Toyota** - Conducted semester-long ethnographic fieldwork across NYC third spaces using contextual inquiry and guerrilla interviews to identify opportunities for community-building initiatives in Woven City.
- Cunard Design System** - Audited Cunard's website to find UI inconsistencies, built a component inventory, created a style guide with primitive and semantic tokens in Figma, and published the system on figma with comprehensive documentation on ZeroHeight.
- Positive Exposure** - Designed an accessibility-first iOS museum companion app for blind and low-vision visitors using SwiftUI.

SKILLS

Design & Prototyping: Figma, Rapid Prototyping, Interactive Prototyping, Wireframes, User Flows, Interaction Design, UI Design, Design Systems, Component Libraries, Responsive Design, Visual Design, Design Thinking, User-Centered Design, Product Thinking.

User Research: User Interviews, Focus Groups, Surveys, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Heuristic Evaluation, Contextual Inquiry, Eye Tracking, Cognitive Walkthroughs, Diary Studies, Field Studies, Ethnography, System Usability Scale (SUS), Net Promoter Score (NPS), Participatory Design, Co-Design Workshops, Affinity Diagramming, Journey Mapping, Empathy Mapping, Personas, Competitive Analysis, Market Research.

Information Architecture & Service Design: Card Sorting, Tree Testing, Navigation Design, Sitemaps, Service Blueprints, Ecosystem Mapping, Stakeholder Mapping, Customer Journeys.

Digital Accessibility: Accessibility, a11y, WCAG 2.2, Accessibility Audits, Inclusive Design, Ethical Design, Screen Reader Compatibility, ARIA, axe DevTools, WAVE, Lighthouse.

Analytics & Data: Google Analytics 4, GA4, SEMrush, Screaming Frog, SEO Audits, Social Media Analytics.

AI & Development: Cursor, Claude Code, Gemini CLI, Codex, Antigravity, Figma Make, Figma MCP, Xcode, AI-Assisted Design, Agentic Development, AI Prompt Engineering, AI-Assisted Research, HTML/CSS Basics, JavaScript Basics, Python, Git, Design-to-Code Handoff.

Collaboration: Cross-Functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Management, Agile Methodology, Scrum Methodology, Design Sprints, Design Critiques, Presentation & Storytelling. **Tools:** Miro, FigJam, Notion, Userlytics, Dscout, Hotjar, Maze, PostHog.